IN SHORT



PUNJAB

› It was **only in 17 seats** that the AAP was not in the fight and the contest was limited to the traditional parties; **57 defectors** from the Akali Dal, BJP and Congress won on AAP tickets

› The Congress's famous **Majha brigade**—with Sukhjinder Randhawa, Tript Rajinder Singh Bajwa, Sukhbinder Sarkaria—who first rebelled against Capt. Amarinder Singh, **all managed to win their respective seats**



› **Parkash Singh Badal, 94, faced his worst defeat in seven decades.** He had last lost a poll in 1967, when he was defeated by Congress stalwart Harcharan Brar at Gidderbaha by 57 votes

UTTARAKHAND

› Education minister **Arvind Pandey won** his Gadarpur seat by 1,120 votes, breaking the long-standing jinx of sitting education ministers losing assembly polls



› With **CM Pushkar Singh Dhami's defeat** in Khatima, the tradition of Uttarakhand CMs losing elections continues. The last incumbent CM to get re-elected was B.S. Koshyari in 2002

– Anilesh S. Mahajan



ANI

UTTAR PRADESH

FIRST FAMILY OF RAMPUR KHAS

While the Congress is often derided for promoting dynastic politics, the Rampur Khas constituency in Uttar Pradesh is proof of the enduring power of political lineage. The party has not lost in this seat since 1980. Veteran Congress leader **Pramod Tiwari** won nine consecutive times from Rampur Khas. Now, his daughter **Aradhana Mishra** has registered her fourth consecutive victory here since 2012—there was a by-poll in 2014—in a grand display of the family's popularity in the region. Despite UP Congress in-charge **Priyanka Gandhi** fielding 40 per cent women candidates, Mishra was the only one who won.

–Kaushik Deka

MANIPUR

A SMOOTH MOVE



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

In Manipur, while the BJP returned to power on its own, the man having the biggest laugh is **Rajkumar Imo Singh**, son-in-law of CM N. Biren Singh. The former Congressman, who joined the BJP in October 2021, was instrumental in the defection of 15 Congress MLAs to the BJP over the past five years. Most of them have now been elected as BJP MLAs, while the Congress tally has plummeted to just five from 28 in 2017. The icing on the cake is that Imo Singh himself won from Sagolband for the third time in a row, a record in itself.

–Kaushik Deka

GOA

The Final Count



The BJP had been trying to win the Ponda seat in Goa for decades, to no avail. This time, it inducted **Ravi Naik**, the former Congress CM, in one last throw of the dice. On March 10, during counting, Naik seemed to be in third place after the MGP and Congress, but in the last round, things changed. Almost every alternate vote was in favour of the septuagenarian. When the results were announced Naik had lost just by one vote. A confident Naik sought a recount and was ultimately announced the winner by a margin of 13 votes. This is the first time that the BJP has won the Hindu dominated seat. Naik, the only Bhandari CM Goa has ever had, is now tipped to be selected Speaker of the assembly.

–Kiran D. Tare